
Hubert Parry

1848–1918, BRITISH

A key figure in the late-19th-century revival of English music, Parry was born into the landowning class. Despite showing precocious musical talent, he followed a traditional path, from schooling at Eton and the University of Oxford to a job in the City of London. Learning composition in his spare time, he emerged as a recognized composer in 1880 with a piano concerto and the influential cantata *Scenes from Prometheus Unbound*. Further large-scale choral works graced English music festivals through the 1880s and 1890s. Parry joined the staff of the Royal College of Music at its foundation in 1883, becoming head in 1894. He was appointed professor of music at the University of Oxford in 1900. Parry was also a prominent writer on music. Failing health led to his retirement from Oxford in 1908, releasing his creative energies for a late flowering that produced the much celebrated anthem “Jerusalem” and the unaccompanied *Songs of Farewell*.

KEY WORKS: *Blest Pair of Sirens* (ode for chorus and orchestra), 1887; *Job* (oratorio), 1892; “Jerusalem” (song), 1916; *Songs of Farewell*, 1916